# ECRS Values For Staff

## What is ECRS?

Founded in 1940, **Eastern Cooperative Recreation School** is devoted to community-building and leadership development through many forms of recreation, including dancing, games, singing, crafts, dramatics, and more. ECRS philosophy is based on the belief that recreation is important for its own sake, as well as an important tool for those who work with people. ECRS encourages its participants to be in community with one another through its functioning as a cooperative.



## What are the ECRS Values?

- **We Value the Group** - ECRS operates as a cooperative, where everyone has a part to play in the many facets of the organization. We trust in, cherish, nurture, and protect the group.
- **We Value Leadership** - Not only does ECRS's leadership development help professionals build interpersonal facilitation skills, it also empowers all members to develop their leadership strengths and interests.
- **We Value the Process** - ECRS events offer an opportunity to learn by participation and practicing in real life. Participants of all ages can try new experiences without judgment.
- **We Value the Individual** - Everyone is encouraged to participate, and every voice is heard through shared learning. Engagement in the group is emphasized over any one individual's influence.

## What is the role of the leader?

We expect all staff to embody our philosophy of **openness**, **trust**, **warmth**, and **support**. ECRS leaders facilitate activities in which everyone can participate, and all ECRS leaders are called upon to model **optimism**, **positivity** and **engagement in the cooperative**. *We create magic when everyone, including the leader, is engaged in the community.*

For more information, please refer to: Of Play and Playfulness: materials, methods and snacks at ten and E.C.R.S. Is !!! by Bob Dunn.